

TURACOS

Confined to Africa, this group includes the strikingly colourful turacos, which are largely green, blue or purple, the dull, greyish go-away birds (named for their distinctive nasal calls), and the plantain-eaters.

In the order Musophagiformes, these birds share certain features with cuckoos, such as foot structure, which appears to be coincidental rather

than indicative of any relationship. They live in forests, subsisting largely on seasonal fruit. Although their bill is remarkably short, a long tail helps them maintain balance when reaching for food in the tree canopy. They move heavily through foliage and fly short distances across forest clearings. Turacos have vividly coloured plumage that derives from green and red pigments, which are uniquely copper-based. Most species in this group have a short, thick, upstanding crest.

PHYLUM	CHORDATA
CLASS	AVES
ORDER	MUSOPHAGIFORMES
FAMILIES	1
SPECIES	23

HARTLAUB'S TURACO

Tauraco hartlaubi
F: Musophagidae

A blue-crested member of the green turaco group, this species is found in highland forest in E. Africa.

43 cm
17 in

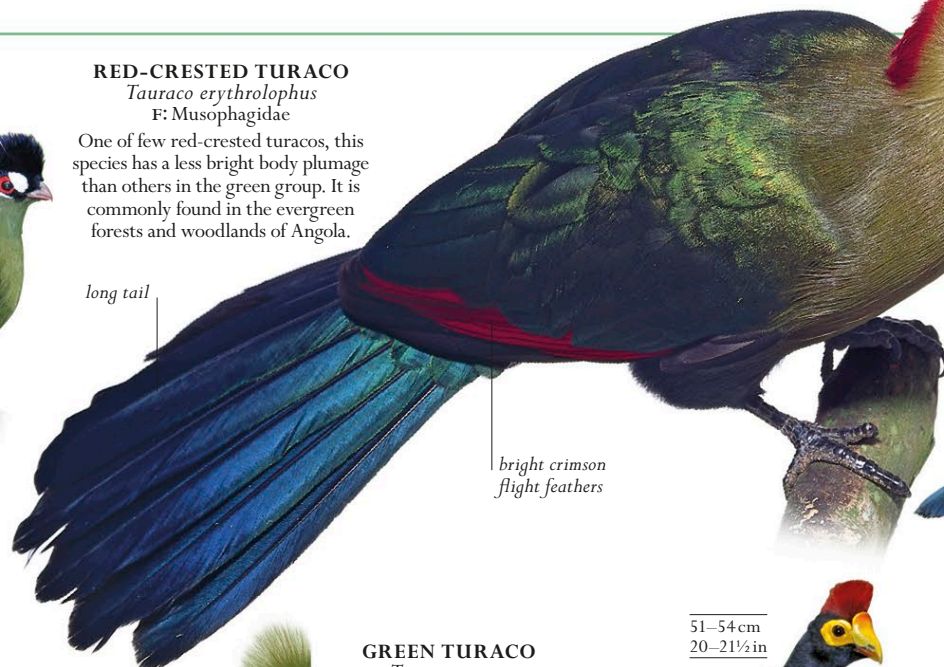


RED-CRESTED TURACO

Tauraco erythrophus
F: Musophagidae

One of few red-crested turacos, this species has a less bright body plumage than others in the green group. It is commonly found in the evergreen forests and woodlands of Angola.

long tail



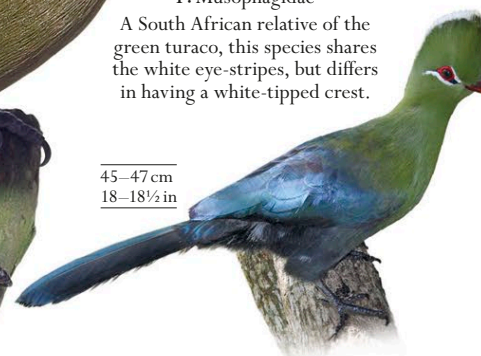
bright crimson
flight feathers

KNYSNA TURACO

Tauraco corythaix
F: Musophagidae

A South African relative of the green turaco, this species shares the white eye-stripes, but differs in having a white-tipped crest.

45–47 cm
18–18½ in



RUSPOLI'S TURACO

Tauraco ruspolii
F: Musophagidae

A distinctively white-crested green turaco, this species has one of the most restricted ranges of any turaco, being confined to forests in S. Ethiopia.

40 cm
16 in

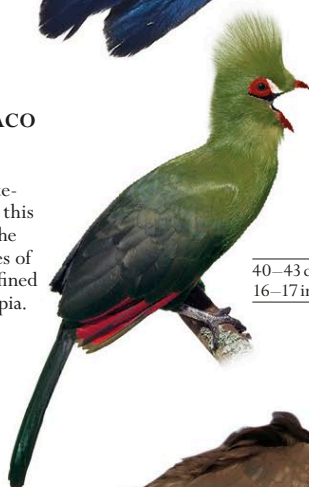


GREEN TURACO

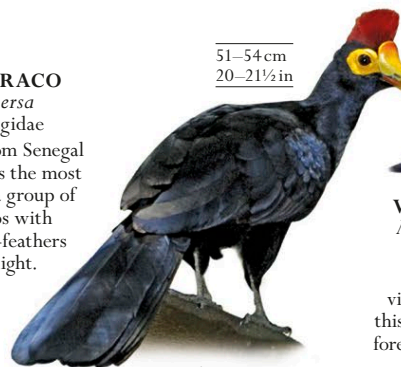
Tauraco persa
F: Musophagidae

With a range from Senegal to Angola, this is the most widespread of a group of green turacos with crimson wing-feathers visible in flight.

40–43 cm
16–17 in



51–54 cm
20–21½ in



ROSS'S TURACO

Musophaga rossae
F: Musophagidae

The second-largest turaco, this species is distinguished by its upright, red crest. It is an E. African counterpart of the violet turaco.

blue body



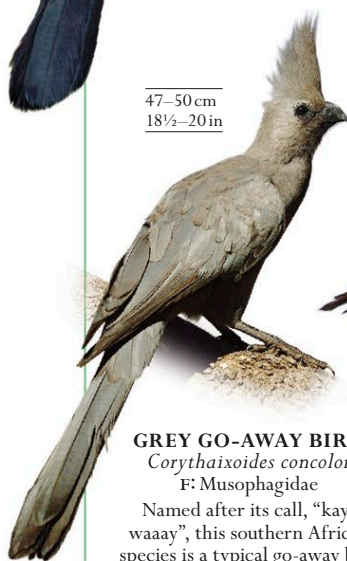
48 cm
19 in

BARE-FACED GO-AWAY BIRD

Corythaixoides personatus
F: Musophagidae

Like other go-away birds, this E. African species is found in savanna woodland. It raises its crest when excited.

long,
broad tail



GREY GO-AWAY BIRD

Corythaixoides concolor
F: Musophagidae

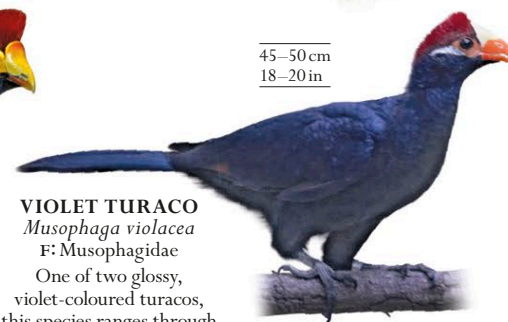
Named after its call, "kay-waaay", this southern African species is a typical go-away bird with a pointed, shaggy crest.

VIOLET TURACO

Musophaga violacea
F: Musophagidae

One of two glossy, violet-coloured turacos, this species ranges through forests of W. and C. Africa.

45–50 cm
18–20 in



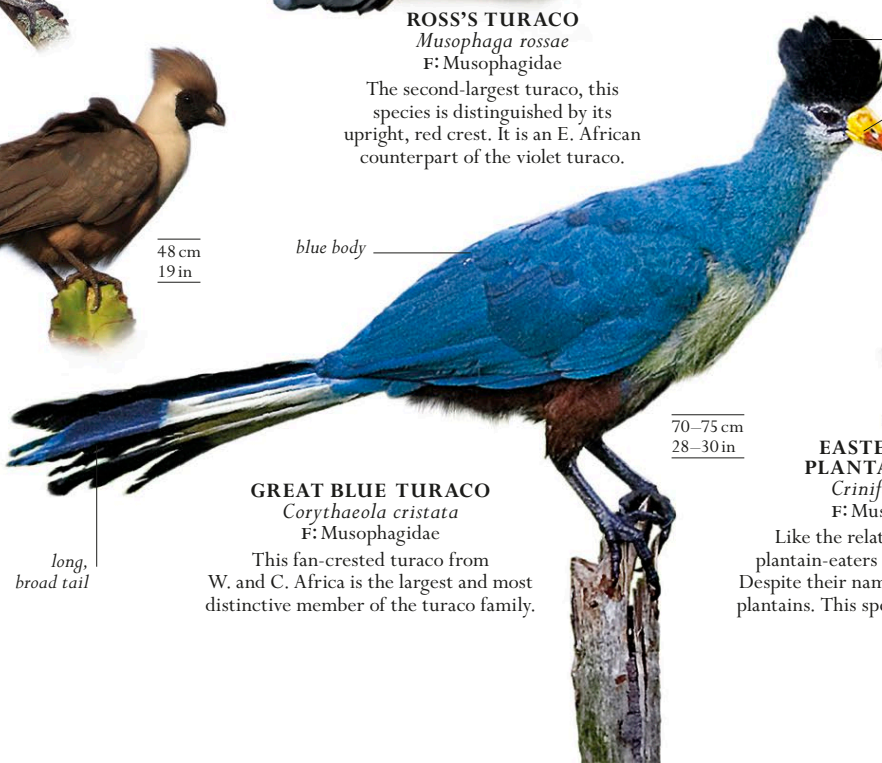
ROSS'S TURACO

Musophaga rossae
F: Musophagidae

The second-largest turaco, this species is distinguished by its upright, red crest. It is an E. African counterpart of the violet turaco.

fan-like crest

yellow bill
with red tip



70–75 cm
28–30 in

GREAT BLUE TURACO

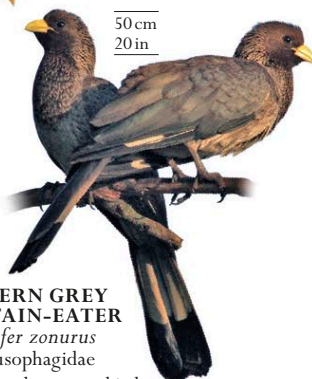
Corythaexola cristata
F: Musophagidae

This fan-crested turaco from W. and C. Africa is the largest and most distinctive member of the turaco family.

EASTERN GREY PLANTAIN-EATER

Crinifer zonurus
F: Musophagidae

Like the related go-away birds, plantain-eaters are drably coloured. Despite their name, they favour figs not plantains. This species is from E. Africa.



50 cm
20 in